

Build Your First Academic Website

Workshop checklist. The details are in the guide:

<https://www.carlislerainey.com/website-workshop/guide.html>

3. Before the workshop

before 2:00

- ☐ GitHub account (github.com/signup) – pick your username carefully
- ☐ GitHub Desktop installed and signed in
- ☐ R and RStudio installed (latest version)
- ☐ A professional headshot, cropped square
- ☐ Your CV as a PDF
- ☐ An ORCID iD (orcid.org/register)
- ☐ Google Scholar profile URL

skip if you don't have a profile yet

5. Make the project in RStudio

Done by 2:15

- ☐ File -> New Project -> New Directory -> Quarto Website
- ☐ Directory name: USERNAME.github.io, all lowercase
- ☐ Check “Create a git repository”
- ☐ Click Create Project

6. Render the site Quarto gave you

Done by 2:20

- ☐ Build tab -> click Render Website

7. Point your site at the docs folder

Done by 2:30

- ☐ Open `_quarto.yml`, select all, delete, paste in the new block
- ☐ Delete the `_site` folder

8. Build your three pages

Done by 2:50

- ☐ Delete `about.qmd`
- ☐ Edit `index.qmd`: paste home-page block; fill in your info
- ☐ New Text File -> paste research block -> Save As `research.qmd`
- ☐ New Text File -> paste teaching block -> Save As `teaching.qmd`

9. Add your photo and your CV

Done by 2:55

- ☐ Copy your headshot and CV into the project folder
- ☐ Rename them `headshot.jpg` and `cv.pdf`

10. Add a .nojekyll file

- ☐ In the Console, run `file.create(".nojekyll")`

11. Check your site before you publish

Done by 3:05

- ☐ Build -> Render Website
- ☐ Open the site in a browser; click through Home, Research, Teaching, CV
- ☐ Fix anything broken

12. Rearrange your home page

Done by 3:05

- ☐ Change template: `jolla` to `trestles`; save; render
- ☐ Try template: `solana`
- ☐ Keep the layout you like

13. Pick a theme

Done by 3:10

- ☐ Change theme: `cosmo` to `flatly`; save; render
- ☐ Try `sandstone`, `litera`, `zephyr`
- ☐ Try `sketchy` or `vapor`, then pick your favorite

14. Publish your site with GitHub Desktop

Done by 3:20

- ☐ Add local repository -> select your project folder
- ☐ Leave all changes checked
- ☐ Summary: “Initial commit” -> Commit to main
- ☐ Uncheck “Keep this code private” -> Publish repository

15. Turn on GitHub Pages

Live by 3:30

- ☐ On github.com: Settings -> Pages
- ☐ Source: Deploy from a branch
- ☐ Branch `main` (or `master`), folder `/docs` -> Save
- ☐ Wait a few minutes; visit your live site

16. Updating your site

- ☐ Edit the `.qmd` file; save
- ☐ Build -> Render Website
- ☐ GitHub Desktop: summary -> Commit to main -> Push origin